

UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX

Undergraduate Examinations 2011

CURRENT DISPUTES IN SOCIOLOGY: SOCIOLOGICAL ANALYSIS III

Time allowed: **TWO** hours

Candidates are permitted to bring into the examination room paper dictionaries (with the title in English).

Candidates must answer **TWO** questions.

The paper consists of **nine** questions in total.

All questions are of equal weight.

Please do not leave your seat unless you are given permission by an invigilator.
Do not communicate in any way with any other candidate in the examination room.
Do not open the question paper until told to do so.
All answers must be written in the answer book(s) provided.
All rough work must be written in the answer book(s) provided. A line should be drawn through any rough work to indicate to the examiner that it is not part of the work to be marked.
At the end of the examination, remain seated until your answer book(s) have been collected and you have been told you may leave.

Candidates must answer TWO questions in total.

1. Are we “docile bodies”?
2. **Either**
 - (a) How have Foucault’s analyses of power aided our broader understanding of political authority today?**or**
 - (b) Statistics are a tool of political oppression. Do you agree?
3. What is “cultural capital”? What are its advantages and limitations for analysing contemporary society?
4. In what sense are “signs” ideological?
5. Is reflexivity the key to modernity?
6. Is post-modernity a new phase of capitalism?
7. What are the challenges facing contemporary feminism?
8. ‘[A] deep chasm has opened up in the metabolic relation between human beings and nature – a metabolism that is the basis of life itself. The source of this unparalleled crisis is the capitalist society in which we live.’ Explain and evaluate this claim.
9. **Either**
 - (a) Examine the role of dialogue in social theory.**or**
 - (b) How significant have social movements been in shaping the development of social theory?

END OF PAPER SC301-6-ZU